

COMMUNITY FM RADIO



Chennai TAMIL NADU

Tuning in to a new frequency

Film music and rock tracks? Forget it, students go easy on entertainment for this on-campus FM radio station.

■ By Akhila Krishnamurthy

The giggles are unstoppable as a gang of girls huddles in a recording studio. They tap their feet, shake their heads in unison, and sing into the microphone, breezing their way through a popular Tamil film song, lyrics for which they have penned themselves.

H K RAJASHEKAR

They aren't experienced vocalists singing for the next big Tamil blockbuster. These are the students of Chennai's M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women, getting ready for their next broadcast at the campus radio station M.O.P FM (107.8). Since its launch in March 2005, the station has been airing content relevant to the community. It represents the voice of a generation that thinks smart and on its feet. It's the voice of a democracy, the voice of a young India, raring to speak and yearning to be heard. And unlike other stations, there are no commercial breaks here. The content is social issues and the brains behind it, the students themselves. While one plays radio jockey and anchors the show, another turns interviewer or hums a tune with a social message. Not surprisingly, occupying pride of place in the programming menu is infotainment that is aesthetically interspersed with elements of wit and humour. "It's in the packaging that we make a difference," says S. Niveetha, a second year undergraduate student of corporate secretaryship. Ah yes, finally, the market speaks.

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THE NUMBER OF RADIO STATIONS ALL INDIA RADIO HAD IN 1947. NOW, THE NUMBER IS 223.



IT'S SHOWTIME:
Students ready
for broadcast